

BONES AND MUSCLES

◆ A newborn baby has more than 300 bones, but as the baby grows some bones fuse together to form larger bones. An adult's skeleton is made up of **206 bones**.

◆ The skeleton makes up around **20 percent of an adult's body weight**.

◆ The body's longest bone—the femur (thighbone)—is **150 times longer** than the smallest—the stirrup bone inside the ear.

◆ The hands contain more than **one-quarter of the body's bones**.

◆ Bones may seem to be dry but are actually **22 percent water**.

◆ We use at least **12 face muscles** while smiling and 11 for frowning.

◆ An average person walks about **80,000 miles (128,000 km)** in a lifetime—the same distance as walking around the world three times.

◆ The bulkiest muscle in the body is the **gluteus maximus** in each buttock, used for powerful actions such as climbing stairs.

HEART AND BLOOD

★ Blood makes up about **8 percent of our body weight**.

★ The heart pumps around **10½ pints (5 liters)** of blood around the body every minute. Each day it pumps enough blood to fill 170 bathtubs.

★ The average length of a capillary is **$\frac{4}{100}$ in (1 mm)**.

★ Spread out flat, the enormous network of capillaries—which deliver oxygen to body cells—would cover an **area the size of 19 tennis courts**.

URINARY SYSTEM

• In an average lifetime, the urinary system makes and releases around **70,000 pints (40,000 liters) of urine**—enough to fill a small swimming pool.

• Every day, around **380 pints (180 liters)** of fluid are filtered from blood by the kidneys, but only 3 pints (1.5 liters) of waste leave the body as urine.

• The kidneys make up just **1 percent of the body's weight** but consume 25 percent of its energy.



More than 10 billion white blood cells are produced daily to destroy invading bacteria.